

is set to use “turbo-charged” settings, which, by its own admission, increases the load on the Web server. The settings can be customised by the user if needed. Fasterfox can also be set to pre-fetch pages when the user is not actively browsing. Pre-fetching allows these pages to be displayed faster when the relevant links are selected, but if the links are not selected, the pages are discarded.

FlashGot

This add-on allows Firefox to be closely integrated with the download manager in the system. The add on cannot do much per se without an external download manager. It adds links in the context menu that allow downloading of page content and also entire Web sites. On selecting the relevant menu option, the default download manager is launched, with the details of the files to be downloaded sent by FlashGot. This add-on facilitates download of image galleries; right-click on any one image in the gallery and select FlashGot. It will download all links on that page using the download manager.

Video downloader

This one lets the user save video from video sites like YouTube (in total, about 60 such sites are supported). Most streaming video sites like YouTube use the Flash Video (.flv) file format for videos. Video Downloader can also download other video formats like QuickTime and even MP3s.

The videos on these sites are downloaded to the browser’s cache as they are being watched. For advanced users, finding the specific file in the browser cache may be easy. Video Downloader lets the user save these files to a different location, thus sparing the user the trouble of wading through the many files in the browser’s cache. The add-on appears as an icon in the browser status bar and clicking on it opens a “download video” window from where the file can be downloaded. To view the files, you will need an appropriate viewer—try Wimpy FLV player (www.wimpyplayer.com/products/wimpy_standalone_flv_player.html) (or <http://tinyurl.com/bdq40>).